The Great Barrier Reef



The Great Barrier reef is the world's largest coral reef system composed of 2,900 individual reefs and 900 islands stretching for about 2,000 kilometres. It covers an area of about 3,50,000 km. The reef is located in the Coral sea, off the coast of Queensland,Australia. The Great Barrier Reef can be seen from the outer space. This sprawling coral reef system is one of the most biologically diverse places on the planet.Coral reefs are built by billions of tiny organisms, known as Coral polyps.CNN labelled it as one of the seven natural wonders of the world.

Recap

- Hydrosphere, the third sphere of Earth, is a collection of all forms of water on the earth.
- Hydrological cycle is the continuous movement of water on Earth.
- Water is available on Earth as fresh and salt water. Over 97% of the water on the Earth's surface is confined to oceans.
- The five major oceans of the world are the Pacific, the Atlantic, the Indian, the Southern and the Arctic ocean.
- The major relief of the ocean floor are continental shelf, continental slope, continental rise, abyssal plains, ocean deeps and ocean ridges.
- Marine resources are nothing but the biotic and abiotic resources found in the oceans.
- Oceans are the lifelines of Earth and mankind. Hence, they need to be conserved.

The Gangetic Dolphin was declared the National Aquatic Animal in 2010. This has become an endangered species. Are the Dolphins really at risk? If so, list out the reasons.



EXERCISE

I Choose the correct answer

1. The temperature of the ocean waters generally_____ at greater depth.
   a) increases b) decreases
   c)remains constant d) none of the above
2. Ocean currents are produced due to _____
   a) due to rotation of earth
   b) due to variation in temperature
   c) due to earth's movement
   d) all the above
3. Consider the following statements.
   1. Most of the fishing grounds occur in areas where the continental shelf is wide.
   2. Fishing is well developed in warm tropical waters.
   3. Mixing of warm and cold currents facilitates plant nutrients for fish.
   4. Inland fishing became significant in India.

   a) 1 and 2 are correct.
   b) 1 and 3 are correct.
   c) 2,3 and 4 are correct.
   d) 1,2 and 3 are correct

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